Higgs Physics at the FCC-μ^+e^- Collider

Production Mechanisms, Polarization, Self-Couplings, and a Collaborative Research Roadmap

A scientific handout for the first FCC-μ^+e^- Higgs-physics collaboration meeting

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Abstract. A polarized high-energy antimuon–electron collider could combine the cleanliness of lepton initial states with multi-TeV electroweak fusion and a distinct experimental complement to FCC-ee. This note reviews the Higgs physics case of the proposed FCC-μe facility, develops the underlying electroweak amplitudes, and reconciles the available leading-order MadGraph calculations. The completed inclusive campaign comprises four Standard Model final states, charged-current (CC) and neutral-current (NC) single- and double-Higgs production, evaluated at exact centre-of-mass energies of 1 and 2 TeV for six positive-muon polarizations. All 48 configurations were produced with an unpolarized electron beam and stable Higgs bosons. The charged-current rates follow the expected $1 + P_{\mu^+}$ enhancement; neutral-current rates rise more weakly, with slopes near 0.22. The strong relative energy growth of hh production motivates direct investigations of the Higgs trilinear self-interaction and $hhVV$ gauge vertices. Earlier $hh \to 4b$, complete four-bottom, associated-$b\bar{b}h$, and muon-collider Zh calculations are reviewed with their distinct cuts and normalization conventions. The genuine MadGraph Feynman diagrams confirm inclusion of the $h^* \to hh$ self-coupling, separate Higgs emissions, and $hhVV$ contact contributions. A physically consistent strategy is proposed for coupling scans, differential measurements, realistic signal/background likelihoods and an exploratory triple-Higgs feasibility test. No anomalous-coupling limits or triple-Higgs cross sections are claimed as completed results.

Key message. The existing LO results form a benchmark and consistency test, *not* a detector-level estimate of coupling precision. The next scientific deliverable is a common, validated hh theory-and-analysis framework for combining CC, NC, polarization and differential information.

1 The proposed FCC-μe facility: kinematics and operating points

For ultrarelativistic head-on beams of energies E_e and E_μ, conservation of four-momentum gives

$$s = (p_e + p_\mu)^2 \simeq 4E_eE_\mu, \qquad \sqrt{s} \simeq 2\sqrt{E_eE_\mu}. \tag{1}$$

Unlike symmetric e^+e^- beams, the highly asymmetric configuration has a boosted centre-of-mass frame. If $+z$ is defined along the incoming antimuon, its rapidity is approximately

$$y_{\mathrm{CM}} = \frac{1}{2}\ln\frac{E_{\mu^+}}{E_{e^-}}; \quad \text{at } (2000, 120)\,\mathrm{GeV}, \quad y_{\mathrm{CM}} \simeq 1.41. \tag{2}$$

Consequently, a central Higgs system in the CM frame may be forward in the laboratory. Acceptance and detector geometry cannot be inferred from an inclusive cross section alone.

Table 1: Two deliberately distinct energy families. The earlier points are approximate FCC-μe machine benchmarks; the later ones are the exact-energy numerical scan.

Study	E_{μ^+}	E_{e^-}	$\sqrt{s}$
Earlier design-like	2 TeV	120 GeV	0.9798 TeV
Earlier design-like	5 TeV	183 GeV	1.9131 TeV
Inclusive cross section scan	2 TeV	125 GeV	1.0000 TeV
Inclusive cross section scan	5 TeV	200 GeV	2.0000 TeV

Piotrzkowski's revised proposal [1] explores a facility based on ultracold μ^+ generation, acceleration and a storage ring, potentially operated with FCC-ee infrastructure. It is a *proposed* machine concept, not an operating collider. The main scientific motivation is access to weak-boson fusion at energies above the traditional Higgsstrahlung regime, without a hadronic beam remnant. The antimuon decay chain also motivates a potentially high-intensity neutrino programme.

The proposal should not be described using a single universal luminosity. Its v2 Table 1 reports two 2-TeV-antimuon working points: $\sqrt{s} = 0.60$ TeV with instantaneous luminosity 4.5×10^{34} and $\sqrt{s} = 0.98$ TeV with $0.63 \times 10^{34}\,\mathrm{cm^{-2}s^{-1}}$. A previous version quoted a different 0.98-TeV example. These are model-dependent performance assumptions, not guaranteed delivered datasets; ab^{-1} projections require live time, availability and luminosity integration.

2 Why complement FCC-ee? Higgs opportunities and experimental constraints

FCC-ee's precision programme emphasizes well-controlled e^+e^- reactions, especially $e^+e^- \to Zh$ around 240 GeV, precise Higgs decay and width information, and complementary measurements near 365 GeV. The FCC Feasibility Study [2] discusses these as prospective capabilities with explicit luminosity and detector assumptions. The proposed FCC-μe does not replace that programme: it probes a different collision regime, including multi-TeV spacelike W and Z exchange, and offers direct tree-level access to hh amplitudes that contain the Higgs trilinear coupling.

In μ^+e^- collisions the incoming lepton flavours differ; ordinary flavour-conserving s-channel annihilation of an e^+e^- or $\mu^+\mu^-$ pair is absent. This changes associated-production backgrounds, but it does not make the physics background-free. For CC fusion, neutrinos carry away longitudinal and transverse momentum. For NC fusion, the scattered electron and antimuon can be very forward, making their acceptance and beam-pipe backgrounds decisive.

Crucial feasibility issues include antimuon source intensity and emittance preservation, muon-decay-induced electromagnetic backgrounds, shielding/nozzle geometry, beam-beam interactions, detector vertex coverage, event reconstruction under substantial boosts, and realistic polarized integrated luminosities. The proposed collision programme therefore requires close integration of Higgs phenomenology with machine and detector parameterizations. Sensitivities must eventually be shown as a function of $\sqrt{s}$, luminosity, beam polarization, forward instrumentation and selection efficiency, not simply inferred by scaling cross sections from another collider.

Complementarity hypothesis: FCC-ee can constrain input hVV couplings and Higgs branching fractions; FCC-μe can add polarization-tagged CC/NC h and hh fusion information, potentially resolving self-coupling and contact-interaction degeneracies in a combined fit. This is a research programme to test, not an already established quantitative improvement.

3 Electroweak symmetry breaking and normalized Higgs interactions

The Higgs field is an $SU(2)_L$ doublet of hypercharge $Y = 1/2$. In unitary gauge its vacuum configuration can be written as $\Phi = (0, (v + h)/\sqrt{2})^T$. The renormalizable scalar and gauge-kinetic Lagrangian contains

$$\mathcal{L}_\Phi = (D_\mu \Phi)^\dagger (D^\mu \Phi) - V(\Phi), \tag{3}$$

$$V(\Phi) = -\mu^2 \Phi^\dagger \Phi + \lambda (\Phi^\dagger \Phi)^2, \qquad v^2 = \mu^2/\lambda. \tag{4}$$

Substituting Φ and eliminating the tadpole at the minimum, $m_h^2 = 2\lambda v^2$, yields the physical scalar potential, up to an irrelevant additive constant,

$$V(h) = \frac{1}{2} m_h^2 h^2 + \frac{m_h^2}{2v} h^3 + \frac{m_h^2}{8v^2} h^4. \tag{5}$$

With the explicit convention $\mathcal{L} \supset -\lambda_3 h^3/3! - \lambda_4 h^4/4!$, the Standard Model values are $\lambda_3^{\rm SM} = 3m_h^2/v$ and $\lambda_4^{\rm SM} = 3m_h^2/v^2$. The associated Feynman rules are $-i\lambda_3$ and $-i\lambda_4$. Using these conventions matters: some references instead call the coefficients in $V(h)$ "the couplings," differing by factorials.

The gauge-boson mass terms obtained from $|D_\mu \Phi|^2$ also fix the one- and two-Higgs interactions:

$$\mathcal{L} \supset m_W^2 W_\mu^+ W^{-\mu} \left(1 + \frac{2h}{v} + \frac{h^2}{v^2}\right) + \frac{1}{2} m_Z^2 Z_\mu Z^\mu \left(1 + \frac{2h}{v} + \frac{h^2}{v^2}\right). \tag{6}$$

Taking functional derivatives yields $hWW:\ 2im_W^2 g_{\mu\nu}/v$ and $hhWW:\ 2im_W^2 g_{\mu\nu}/v^2$, with the analogous Z rules after the identical-field factors are included. At tree level, these couplings are correlated by the doublet structure; independent effective modifications require a declared parameterization.

For the physics programme it is useful to introduce κ_W, κ_Z, κ_{2W}, κ_{2Z}, κ_3 and κ_4 as ratios of corresponding vertices to the SM values. A universal κ_{2V} is a shorthand only if the selected theory links the $hhWW$ and $hhZZ$ shifts. The single-Higgs channels primarily test hVV at tree level; double Higgs combines hVV, $hhVV$ and the self-interaction.

4 Weak-boson fusion, helicity, interference, and unitarity

The dominant Higgs-production mechanism of interest is the exchange of spacelike electroweak bosons from the incoming charged leptons. A schematic factorized expression is

$$\mathrm{d}\sigma(\mu^+e^- \to X + h^{(n)}) \sim \sum_{V_1V_2,\lambda_1\lambda_2} f^{\lambda_1}_{V_1/\mu^+} \otimes f^{\lambda_2}_{V_2/e^-} \otimes \mathrm{d}\hat{\sigma}(V_1V_2 \to h^{(n)}), \tag{7}$$

where $n = 1, 2, 3$. This effective-vector-boson language is valuable for interpreting the high-energy behaviour, but is not a replacement for the full gauge-consistent $2 \to 3, 4, 5$ matrix element. The bosons are typically off shell, the exact final-state kinematics matter, and interference among physical tree graphs must be retained.

For longitudinal weak bosons, the Goldstone-boson equivalence theorem exposes the cancellations implied by symmetry breaking. In a common nonlinear Higgs effective description,

$$\frac{v^2}{4}\mathrm{Tr}\left[(D_\mu U)^\dagger D^\mu U\right]\left(1 + 2a\frac{h}{v} + b\frac{h^2}{v^2} + \cdots\right), \tag{8}$$

the energy-growing term in $V_LV_L \to hh$ is, up to overall phase and sign conventions, proportional to $(b - a^2)s/v^2$. It cancels at leading power in the SM ($a = b = 1$). A departure between $hhVV$ and $(hVV)^2$ modifies this cancellation and may enhance the high-m_{hh} tail. This motivates simultaneous control of κ_V and κ_{2V} rather than interpreting a total hh cross section only in terms of κ_3.

The off-shell self-coupling contribution contains a scalar propagator $(m^2_{hh} - m^2_h)^{-1}$ and is often relatively influential closer to the hh threshold. However, no individual graph defines a separately measurable "self-coupling cross section." Schematically,

$$\sigma_{hh} \propto \int \mathrm{d}\Phi \, \left|\mathcal{M}_{hhVV} + \mathcal{M}_{\text{separate}} + \mathcal{M}_{h^*\to hh}\right|^2. \tag{9}$$

The squares and cross terms may differ greatly over phase space. Only a complete amplitude, or an explicitly valid gauge-invariant operator expansion, is a robust basis for a parameter fit. This distinction is central to Krzysztof's original diagram question and to the collaboration's future anomalous-coupling scan.

5 Charged-current single Higgs: $\mu^+e^- \to \bar{\nu}_\mu \nu_e h$

The charged-current (CC) single-Higgs process is generated by the complete LO Standard Model command

```
generate e- mu+ > ve vm~ h QCD=0
```

The two incoming charged leptons radiate weak charged currents, which fuse through the hWW vertex. At the amplitude level the process tests the $SU(2)_L$ structure of the weak current together with the hWW coupling. It is therefore the natural high-statistics calibration channel for subsequent CC double-Higgs studies. It does not contain a tree-level $h^* \to hh$ self-coupling contribution, and a single inclusive rate alone cannot disentangle hWW strength from luminosity, polarization or decay normalization.

For negligible lepton masses, an electron charged current selects a left-handed electron and a positive antimuon of right helicity. Let $P_{e^-} = (N_R - N_L)/(N_R + N_L)$ for electrons and analogously P_{μ^+} for antimuons. With helicity fractions $(1 - P_{e^-})/2$ and $(1 + P_{\mu^+})/2$, and only one CC initial-helicity combination contributing at leading power,

$$\sigma_{\mathrm{CC}}(P_{e^-}, P_{\mu^+}) \simeq (1 - P_{e^-})(1 + P_{\mu^+})\, \sigma_{\mathrm{CC}}(0, 0). \tag{10}$$

This counts relative to the unpolarized average. With the actual study's $P_{e^-} = 0$, the enhancement is $R_{\mathrm{CC}} = 1 + p$, where $p = P_{\mu^+}/100$.

The completed exact-energy simulation gives $\sigma_{\mathrm{CC}h}(0) = 210.540 \pm 0.209$ fb at 1 TeV and 386.010 ± 0.303 fb at 2 TeV. At +80% polarization these become 378.570 ± 0.243 and 695.000 ± 0.614 fb. The corresponding normalized rate enhancements of approximately 1.8 provide a clear check of beam-polarization implementation. Errors quoted here are Monte Carlo integration uncertainties only. A practical hWW determination would exploit several Higgs decay channels with controlled efficiencies and backgrounds, fit the acceptance-corrected rate, and combine FCC-ee or other inputs to break branching-ratio and total-width degeneracies.

The immediate differential observables are Higgs transverse momentum and rapidity, missing transverse momentum, and angular correlations with reconstructed Higgs decays. Their laboratory distributions are strongly influenced by the asymmetric beam boost, meaning that η acceptance and momentum coverage must be included before inferring sensitivity.

6 Neutral-current single Higgs: $\mu^+e^- \to \mu^+e^-h$

The complete NC process uses

```
generate e- mu+ > e- mu+ h QCD=0
```

and contains the tree-level neutral weak-boson fusion amplitude. Both outgoing charged leptons can populate small scattering angles. Even when the total inclusive weak-fusion rate is finite, an experimentally useful prediction requires realistic acceptance, beam-pipe masking, and stability scans in the forward region. A numerical "no-cuts" result is not automatically a detector fiducial prediction.

At high energy, both left- and right-chiral charged leptons couple to Z, with dimensionless coefficients (stripping the common g/c_W factor)

$$g_L = -\tfrac{1}{2} + s_W^2, \qquad g_R = s_W^2, \qquad s_W^2 \equiv \sin^2\theta_W. \tag{11}$$

If the neutral-boson-fusion amplitude has approximately the same kinematic weighting for the corresponding positive-muon helicities, the inclusive polarization ratio is

$$R_{\rm NC}(p) \simeq 1 + A_{\rm NC}p, \quad A_{\rm NC} \simeq \frac{g_L^2 - g_R^2}{g_L^2 + g_R^2}. \tag{12}$$

The antimuon helicity convention interchanges the particle-chirality language, so the sign of $A_{\rm NC}$ should always be defined with the beam convention explicitly. Equation (12) is a leading pure-Z approximation: exact full-process predictions depend on the electroweak input scheme and any subleading amplitudes. The MG5 parameter card should be consulted before assigning a specific numerical weak mixing angle.

The MG results give $\sigma_{{\rm NC}h}(0) = 20.835 \pm 0.025$ fb at 1 TeV and 38.991 ± 0.030 fb at 2 TeV. At +80% antimuon polarization, the results are 24.476 ± 0.015 and 45.829 ± 0.055 fb, respectively. Thus the NC enhancement is about 17.5

Experimentally, the final-state electron and antimuon may permit useful event classification, but only if both can be tagged with credible angular and energy coverage. A differential NC analysis should keep $p_T^{e,\mu}$, $\eta_{e,\mu}$ and momentum-transfer distributions, not merely $\sigma({\rm NC}h)$. Combining this with CC data offers a complementary test of hZZ/hWW interactions and their electroweak correlations.

7 Double-Higgs production: physics content and coupling dependence

For charged-current and neutral-current channels the unrestricted MG5 processes are, respectively,

```
generate e- mu+ > ve vm~ h h QCD=0
generate e- mu+ > e- mu+ h h QCD=0
```

The Higgs-pair amplitude contains three structurally distinct tree-level mechanisms: a direct $hhVV$ contact interaction, diagrams with Higgs bosons emitted through separate hVV vertices and an intermediate off-shell scalar with $V^*V^* \to h^* \to hh$. The third mechanism depends on the trilinear coupling λ_3. Neither the contact topology nor the separately emitted Higgs topology may be removed while retaining a claim to the *full* SM cross section.

With κ_W, κ_Z denoting single-Higgs gauge coupling modifiers and κ_{2W}, κ_{2Z} the relevant contact modifiers, a phenomenological amplitude may be schematically organized as

$$\mathcal{M}_{hh} = \kappa_{2V}\mathcal{M}_c^{\mathrm{SM}} + \kappa_V^2\mathcal{M}_t^{\mathrm{SM}} + \kappa_V\kappa_3\mathcal{M}_s^{\mathrm{SM}}, \tag{13}$$

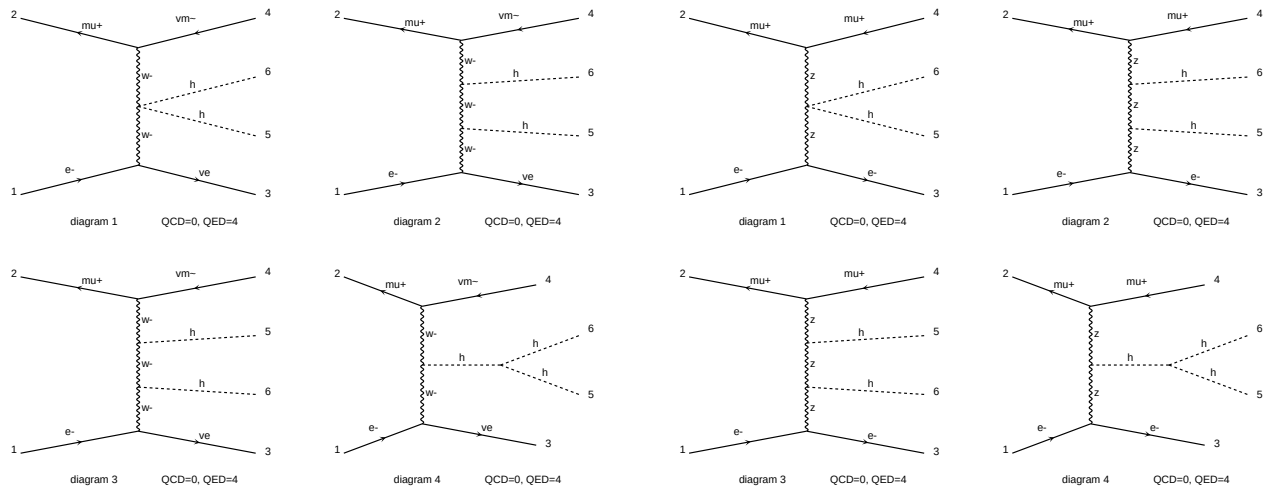
with $V = W$ for CC and $V = Z$ for NC, and with a definition of the modified theory required to make the decomposition precise. For fixed other parameters, $\sigma_{hh}(\kappa_3) = c_0 + c_1\kappa_3 + c_2\kappa_3^2$. The coefficient c_1 is a physically important interference term and can be negative. A total-rate measurement may admit two distinct κ_3 solutions; the m_{hh} distribution and correlated channels can help resolve this ambiguity.

The SM inclusive unpolarized CC double-Higgs rate grows from 0.0743838 ± 0.0001274 fb at exact 1 TeV to 0.418510 ± 0.0006568 fb at 2 TeV, a factor 5.63. For NC double H the corresponding rates are 0.00962012 ± 0.0000146 and 0.0547116 ± 0.0000851 fb, a factor 5.69. This is substantially larger relative energy growth than for single H, consistent with increased multi-particle phase space and vector-boson luminosities.

Nevertheless, κ_3 has *not* yet been scanned in these 48 SM runs. The existing physics potential is a motivation and a design input for such a study, not a realized coupling constraint. The central research objective is to identify which combination of rate, threshold spectrum and polarization is robust against correlated hVV and $hhVV$ modifications.

8 Original MG Feynman diagrams: an explicit amplitude check

Krzysztof asked whether the calculations include both $h^* \to hh$ through the trilinear self-interaction and the diagrams in which the two Higgs bosons couple separately to weak bosons. The original process exports answer this directly. Each of the two hh processes contains four tree-level diagrams, as labeled in the original MadGraph files: diagram 1 is the $hhWW$ or $hhZZ$ contact term, diagrams 2 and 3 are separate hVV emission topologies, and diagram 4 contains the off-shell scalar $h^* \to hh$. All four contribute coherently to the original generator-level cross sections.



(a) CC $e^-\mu^+ \to \nu_e \bar{\nu}_\mu hh$. **(b)** NC $e^-\mu^+ \to e^-\mu^+ hh$.

Figure 1: Genuine original MadGraph vector diagrams, preserved without substituting generic literature illustrations. The diagram IDs follow the source exports.

Interpretation. The full differential rate contains all squared and interference terms, for example $2\,\mathrm{Re}(\mathcal{M}_{h^*}\mathcal{M}^*_{hhVV})$.

Separately counting diagrams or omitting contact terms would not yield a universal, gauge-invariant extraction of a "self-coupling contribution." The model must be varied consistently at the amplitude level. A next useful cross-check is to rerun selected reference points after varying κ_3 in a validated EFT/HEFT implementation and explicitly verify the anticipated polynomial dependence.

9 The MG polarization campaign: reproducibility and results

The completed campaign used MG5_aMC v3.6.4 at LO with four processes, two *exact* centre-of-mass energies and six positive-muon beam polarizations $P_{\mu^+} = 0, 20, 40, 60, 80, 100\%$. The electron was beam 1 and unpolarized, and the antimuon beam 2. Higgs particles were stable and no generation-level phase-space cuts were imposed. Each of the $4 \times 2 \times 6 = 48$ jobs requested/generated 30,000 events.

Table 2: Selected inclusive cross sections (fb). Values are from the machine-readable source CSV; the uncertainties are generator Monte Carlo integration errors only.

$\sqrt{s}$	Channel	$P = 0\%$	$P = 80\%$	$P = 100\%$
1 TeV	CC h	210.540	378.570	421.150
	CC hh	0.074384	0.133230	0.148239
	NC h	20.835	24.476	25.402
	NC hh	0.009620	0.011308	0.011723
2 TeV	CC h	386.010	695.000	772.690
	CC hh	0.418510	0.754495	0.839521
	NC h	38.991	45.829	47.642
	NC hh	0.054712	0.064299	0.066770

To illustrate source precision rather than imply experimental accuracy, $\sigma(\mathrm{CC}hh, 2\,\mathrm{TeV}, 80\%) = 0.754495 \pm 0.001277$ fb. The quoted uncertainty is generated by the integration algorithm; it excludes uncertainty from missing higher orders, model parameters, collinear/forward treatment, detector response and machine conditions.

10 Polarization fits, cross-section ratios, and diagnostic plots

For each process and energy the reported analysis fits the cross section as $\sigma(p) = a(1 + Ap)$, where $p = P_{\mu^+}/100$. The inferred slopes are obtained from the absolute cross sections, avoiding treatment of multiple ratios with a common random denominator as independent observations.

Table 3: Numerical-fit polarization slopes A. These are fit/integration errors, not collider measurements.

Channel	1 TeV	2 TeV
CC h	0.9982 ± 0.0020	1.0007 ± 0.0018
CC hh	0.9934 ± 0.0040	1.0053 ± 0.0039
NC h	0.2181 ± 0.0012	0.2208 ± 0.0011
NC hh	0.2186 ± 0.0022	0.2204 ± 0.0022

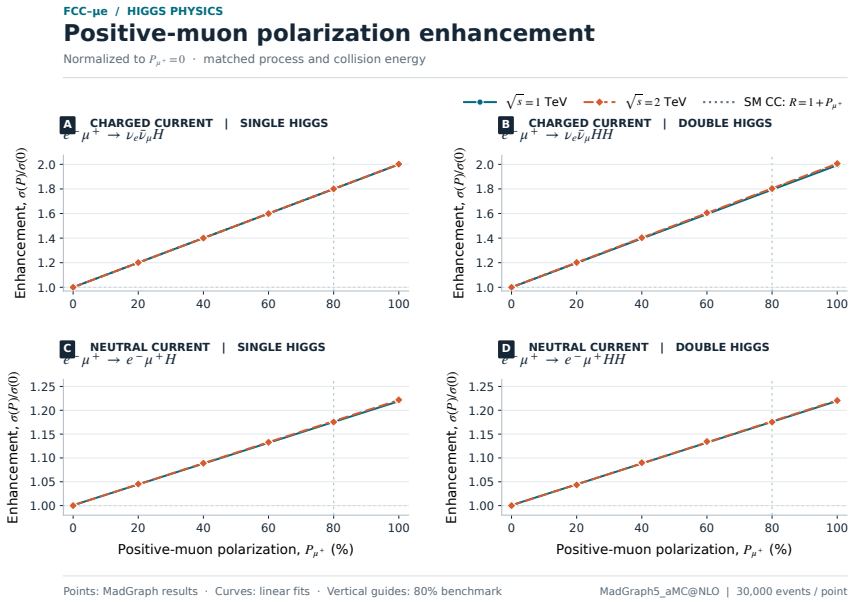


Figure 2: Ratios $\sigma(P)/\sigma(0)$ in the four inclusive channels, from the original 48 MG runs. The CC slope is near 1, whereas the NC slope is near 0.22. Error bars reflect numerical integration.

The separation of CC and NC slopes is the cleanest physical finding: for +80% antimuon polarization, the CC rate enhancement is close to 1.8, while the NC enhancement is about 1.175. The relative growth from exact 1 to 2 TeV is 1.833 for CC h, 1.871 for NC h, 5.626 for CC hh, and 5.687 for NC hh at $P = 0$. The close similarity of the NC h and hh slopes indicates that the dominant helicity dependence arises in the initial Z-current factors. It is not, by itself, a determination of the weak mixing angle: luminosity, polarization calibration, coupling correlations and realistic fiducial phase space remain indispensable.

11 Charged-current $hh \to 4b$: resonant and complete final states

An earlier MG programme investigated $e^-\mu^+ \to \nu_e\bar{\nu}_\mu hh \to \nu_e\bar{\nu}_\mu b\bar{b}b\bar{b}$ and the corresponding complete $e^-\mu^+ \to \nu_e\bar{\nu}_\mu b\bar{b}b\bar{b}$ final state. Parallel comparisons were made with symmetric $\mu^+\mu^-$ collisions. These older results are *fiducial parton-level* calculations; they must not be equated with the later stable-Higgs inclusive rates.

The selection requires four bottom/antibottom partons satisfying $|\eta_b| < 5$ and two distinct opposite-charge $b\bar{b}$ combinations each within $110 < m_{b\bar{b}} < 130$ GeV, without a minimum bottom-parton p_T cut. This is a generator-level pairing/selection, not realistic jet clustering, bottom tagging or detector Higgs reconstruction. The actual pairing algorithm and any neutrino-flavour sums should be treated as part of the source run-card definition.

Table 4: Selected historical fiducial cross sections [fb]. Entries are $P_{\mu^+} = 0\%/80\%$ for the studied configurations.

Collider	$\sqrt{s}$	Resonant $hh \to 4b$	Complete $\nu\bar{\nu}4b$
FCC-μe	0.980 TeV	0.04912 / 0.08816	0.05355 / 0.09195
$\mu^+\mu^-$	1.000 TeV	0.07047 / 0.11582	0.07530 / 0.12472
FCC-μe	1.913 TeV	0.26478 / 0.47611	0.28157 / 0.50745
$\mu^+\mu^-$	2.000 TeV	0.30624 / 0.54606	0.32480 / 0.57873

The complete final-state amplitude includes resonant, singly resonant, nonresonant and interference pieces. It is therefore invalid to identify the "background" as the complete 4b cross section minus the resonant hh sample without a consistent amplitude-level and event-definition analysis. Double counting is also possible if independently generated hh, $b\bar{b}h$ and complete 4b samples are naively added.

A critical numerical caveat is that the earlier model card used $\mathrm{BR}(h \to b\bar{b}) = 0.844640$, whereas a conventional 125-GeV SM prediction is approximately 0.582 [4]. The resonant double-decay probability is affected quadratically. One must harmonize branching ratios or regenerate samples before projecting experimental yields; a simple rescaling is not generally appropriate for the complete interfering amplitude.

12 NC four-bottom channels, associated $b\bar{b}h$, and muon Zh

The neutral-current historical portfolio studied $e^-\mu^+ \to e^-\mu^+hh \to e^-\mu^+4b$, associated $e^-\mu^+ \to e^-\mu^+b\bar{b}h \to e^-\mu^+4b$, the complete $e^-\mu^+4b$ amplitude, and a diagnostic sample excluding internal Higgs contributions. The earlier NC event generation imposed $p_{T,\ell} > 1$ GeV on outgoing charged leptons in addition to the four-bottom angular and 110–130 GeV pairing selections. Thus these are emphatically not the uncut inclusive NC rates shown on pp. 10–11.

Table 5: Preliminary NC fiducial cross sections at approximately 0.980 TeV, unpolarized.

Channel	σ_{fid} [fb]
NC $hh \to 4b$	0.006382
Associated $b\bar{b}h \to 4b$	0.012925
Complete $e^-\mu^+4b$	0.007713
Higgs-excluded continuum diagnostic	0.0008253

The continuum estimate is limited by 88 accepted events among 50,000 generated. There is also a *specific unresolved consistency problem*: the full-NC-4b rate is below the separately generated associated-$b\bar{b}h$ rate. One cannot conclude that interference alone explains this ordering, because process definitions, cuts, normalization and Monte Carlo convergence must first be reconciled. This mismatch is an actionable audit task, not an established interference measurement. Higher-energy associated-$b\bar{b}h$ examples (~ 0.081843 fb at FCC-μe 1.913 TeV and ~ 0.094913 fb at $\mu^+\mu^-$ 2 TeV, both at +80% in their reported configurations) remain preliminary pending cut-level verification.

A distinct benchmark is $\mu^+\mu^- \to Zh \to (b\bar{b})(b\bar{b})$: at 1 TeV the LO cross section before/after the selected cuts is 1.56450/1.52716 fb, while at 2 TeV it is 0.37888/0.36929 fb. These runs used $|\eta_b| < 5$ and two assigned $b\bar{b}$ masses in the *wider* 80–130 GeV window, without a minimum bottom-parton p_T cut. The flavour-diagonal s-channel annihilation contribution of $\mu^+\mu^-$ has no ordinary neutral-current μ^+e^- analogue. The final state is also distinct from neutrino-associated $hh \to \nu\bar{\nu}4b$.

13 From inclusive cross sections to observable event samples

An inclusive LO production rate is only the first factor in a realistic sensitivity analysis. For a specified exclusive signal selection i, the expected event yield takes the schematic form

$$N_i = \mathcal{L}_{\text{int}} \sum_c \sigma_c(\boldsymbol{\kappa})\, \text{BR}_c(\boldsymbol{\kappa})\, \varepsilon_{c,i}(\boldsymbol{\kappa}, \boldsymbol{\theta}) + B_i(\boldsymbol{\theta}), \tag{14}$$

where c indexes physical signal/decay channels, ε includes fiducial acceptance and reconstruction, $\boldsymbol{\theta}$ denotes nuisance parameters and B_i is background. The production coupling and Higgs decay parameters may be correlated, so a consistent width/branching-ratio treatment is required.

As an explicitly *illustrative*, not established FCC-μe luminosity assumption, take $\mathcal{L}_{\text{int}} = 3\,\text{ab}^{-1}$ and $P_{\mu^+} = +80\%$. The reported inclusive CC hh rates imply $N_{hh} \approx 400$ produced pairs at 1 TeV and ≈ 2263 at 2 TeV before Higgs decays and acceptance; the corresponding NC yields are about 34 and 193. If both Higgs bosons decay to $b\bar{b}$ with a representative SM branching fraction 0.582, the raw $4b$ fraction is $(0.582)^2 \simeq 0.339$. A naive four-tag factor ε_b^4, e.g. $(0.7)^4 \simeq 0.24$, would reduce this further, even before kinematic cuts, jet pairing, showering, backgrounds and beam-induced effects. None of these illustrative factors can be taken as a detector-level efficiency estimate.

Potential discriminants include reconstructed m_{hh}, two $m_{b\bar{b}}$ peaks, angular separation of b jets, total visible energy, missing transverse momentum and NC final-state charged-lepton tags. The correct background model must incorporate genuine irreducible final-state amplitudes, reducible heavy flavour and mistags where relevant, as well as detector/beam-induced background overlays. The energy-asymmetric machine changes object rapidities, particularly the outgoing charged leptons in NC events. Finally, the running programme must specify whether a given polarization setting retains the same delivered luminosity: a factor 1.8 in CC cross section does not automatically yield a factor 1.8 improvement in precision.

14 A Higgs-coupling measurement programme: parameters and theory control

A quantitative study should begin with a declared parameter basis. In a phenomenological HEFT-like normalization, choose the set $\{\kappa_W, \kappa_Z, \kappa_{2W}, \kappa_{2Z}, \kappa_3\}$; the quartic κ_4 can be introduced when assessing triple Higgs. The single-H CC and NC samples help constrain the two hVV factors, while hh rates and shapes add information about $hhVV$ and λ_3. If the target is a one-parameter κ_3 projection, it must explicitly say that the other couplings are fixed to their SM values; otherwise the inferred constraint is generally not robust.

A useful fit sequence is: (i) fit single-H production and branching information to control κ_W, κ_Z and normalization nuisances; (ii) evaluate hh coefficient templates at several physically consistent anomalous-coupling points; (iii) combine total and differential yields at both energies and beam polarizations; and (iv) profile over nuisance parameters and correlated gauge-Higgs variations. The rate-only $\sigma_{hh}(\kappa_3)$ is a quadratic polynomial at fixed other couplings, but a multidimensional fit can have richer interference structure and degenerate contours. No coupling limits have been produced by the current 48-run SM scan.

In a linear gauge-invariant SMEFT, the scalar doublet transforms under $SU(2)_L \times U(1)_Y$ and effective operators correlate the modifications of hVV, $hhVV$, fermionic currents and other amplitudes. A HEFT parameterization treats the physical scalar more flexibly and may allow distinct coefficients a and b in the Goldstone sector. Both are useful, but they answer different questions. An EFT study must specify operator normalization, input-parameter scheme, truncation order (linear versus quadratic in Wilson coefficients), renormalization scale if relevant, and the domain of validity $E < \Lambda$ of the expansion.

One physically motivated separation uses κ_3 to modify the off-shell scalar-mediated part and κ_{2V} to modify the two-Higgs gauge contact. Yet those apparent "directions" are not automatically independent parameters of a given gauge-invariant SMEFT truncation. For first exploratory grids they may be treated within a validated HEFT model; a complementary SMEFT interpretation can then translate observable patterns into operator coefficients subject to matching and unitarity constraints. Existing detector-level electron–muon $hhWW$ phenomenology must be cited as prior art, notably Cao *et al.* [3]. The new contribution should be a coherent combined CC/NC, polarization and shape analysis with realistic machine assumptions.

15 Differential observables and interference-based discrimination

A total hh cross section compresses potentially useful kinematic information. The most direct differential variable is $m_{hh} = \sqrt{(p_{h_1} + p_{h_2})^2}$, which samples the virtual-Higgs propagator and the high-energy contact/gauge exchange contributions differently. Further observables include $p_{T,h}$, the hh system transverse momentum and rapidity, the opening angle between Higgs bosons, and the momentum transfers to outgoing leptons in NC events. In CC events, missing transverse momentum and the distribution of visible Higgs decay products help select the weak-fusion topology.

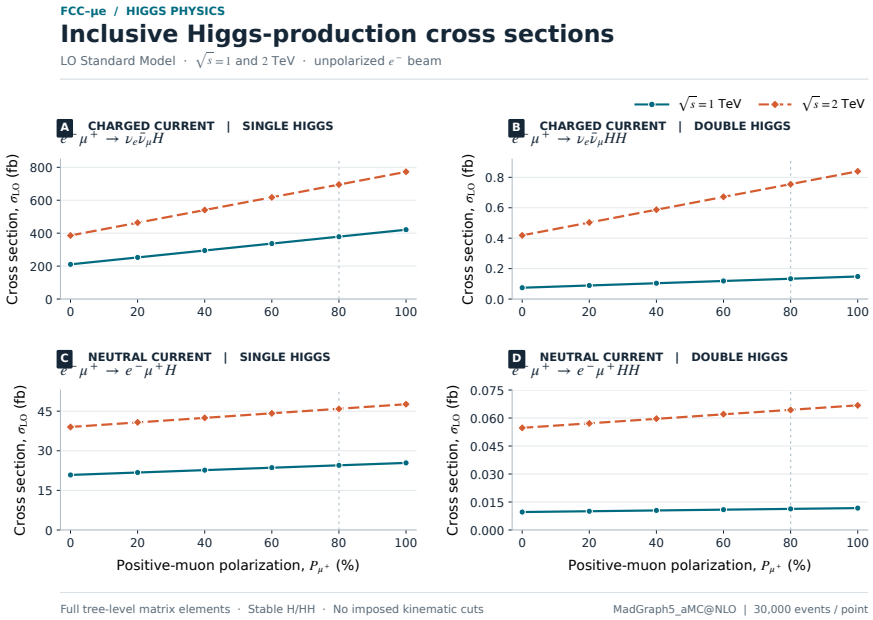


Figure 3: Source-derived LO single- and double-Higgs inclusive cross sections at exact 1 and 2 TeV versus the six positive-muon polarization points. The figure is a baseline for future *differential* anomalous-coupling studies, not an anomalous-coupling prediction.

The high-m_{hh} tail may be sensitive to anomalous $hhVV$ interactions when the Standard Model high-energy cancellations are modified. Near threshold, the relative influence of the trilinear scalar exchange can be larger. Both observations depend on selections: a highly boosted configuration or tight visible acceptance can sculpt the distributions, and a power-enhanced EFT contribution at large momentum transfer may approach the validity limit of the EFT itself. Thus the final fit must compare finite detector-level bins, not extrapolate an unregulated partonic tail into an arbitrarily high-energy region.

For reliable numerical templates, use common electroweak inputs and process cuts across all coupling points, independent seeds for selected spot checks, and explicit event-sample overlap rules for resonant and complete amplitudes. Retain full systematic covariance or nuisance parameter effects rather than turning each bin's Monte Carlo integration error into an experimental uncertainty. A source-controlled analysis should archive both the generator parameters and a compact histogram production code.

16 From cross sections to likelihoods and projected sensitivity

A genuine measurement projection needs a statistical model and backgrounds. For observed counts n_i in bins of m_{hh}, lepton kinematics and event categories, define the expected bin content

$$\mu_i(\boldsymbol{\kappa}, \boldsymbol{\theta}) = \mathcal{L}_{\text{int}} \sum_c \sigma_{c,i}(\boldsymbol{\kappa})\, \text{BR}_c(\boldsymbol{\kappa})\, \varepsilon_{c,i}(\boldsymbol{\theta}) + b_i(\boldsymbol{\theta}), \tag{15}$$

where $\boldsymbol{\theta}$ describes integrated luminosity, antimuon polarization calibration, tagging efficiency, acceptance, background normalization/shape and theory effects. A standard binned likelihood is

$$\mathcal{L}(\boldsymbol{\kappa}, \boldsymbol{\theta}) = \prod_i \frac{\mu_i^{n_i} e^{-\mu_i}}{n_i!} \prod_a \pi_a(\theta_a), \qquad q(\boldsymbol{\kappa}) = -2 \ln \frac{\mathcal{L}(\boldsymbol{\kappa}, \hat{\boldsymbol{\theta}}_{\boldsymbol{\kappa}})}{\mathcal{L}(\hat{\boldsymbol{\kappa}}, \hat{\boldsymbol{\theta}})}. \tag{16}$$

The profile construction makes the underlying uncertainty assumptions explicit. Asimov datasets can be used for expected constraints only *after* signals, backgrounds and nuisance models are specified. For Poisson bins with known background the expected information scales schematically as $I_{ab} = \sum_i (\partial_a \mu_i)(\partial_b \mu_i)/\mu_i$; the matrix can be singular if two coupling directions yield nearly identical spectra. This motivates complementary CC and NC processes, multiple energies and beam-polarization settings.

A minimal baseline sensitivity scenario should record: actual feasible luminosity for each beam configuration, Higgs branching-ratio correlations with $\boldsymbol{\kappa}$, fiducial acceptances from detector simulation, main irreducible and reducible backgrounds, treatment of forward electrons and antimuons, and higher-order electroweak uncertainties. A "statistical only" scenario may be included for transparency but must be visibly distinct from a robust experimental projection. Likewise a literature estimate quoted in the FCC-μe proposal is a tentative rescaling of muon-collider expectations, not a measured or directly calculated κ_3 limit from the present work.

The concrete output of the next phase should be likelihood-ready binned templates and their provenance, not merely another table of inclusive SM cross sections. A blinded internal validation should first reproduce the known SM rates and the analytic CC polarization dependence, then check closure tests on injected nonstandard coupling points.

17 Triple Higgs and the quartic self-coupling: a feasibility test

A forward extension is charged-current $e^-\mu^+ \to \nu_e\bar{\nu}_\mu hhh$ and neutral-current $e^-\mu^+ \to e^-\mu^+ hhh$, whose proposed unrestricted SM MadGraph commands are

```
generate e- mu+ > ve vm~ h h h QCD=0
generate e- mu+ > e- mu+ h h h QCD=0
```

The $VV \to hhh$ amplitudes can involve the quartic self-coupling λ_4, one or more trilinear λ_3 insertions and gauge-Higgs contact/propagation contributions. Consequently, hhh could, in principle, complement hh by accessing a qualitatively new combination of Higgs-potential parameters. It is not a clean isolated measurement of κ_4: other couplings and interference remain essential.

The minimum on-shell invariant mass is $m_{hhh} \geq 3m_h \simeq 375$ GeV. At exact 1 and 2 TeV the initial lepton CM energy is above threshold, but the virtual weak bosons carry only a fraction of that energy and phase space is restricted. Small SM rates, limited polarization-specific luminosity, complicated multibody final states and beam/detector backgrounds may make the measurement unfeasible. No numerical hhh cross section has yet been computed in this project, and no quartic-coupling sensitivity should be invented.

A sensible initial campaign computes CC and NC SM rates at 1 and 2 TeV for $P_{\mu^+} = 0, 80, 100\%$, with stable Higgs bosons and independently audited integration. The expected CC enhancement $\sim 1 + p$ provides a further cross-check. Only if numerically stable rates are appreciable should the study advance to decays and to a κ_3–κ_4 scan. For a transparent *illustrative* integrated luminosity $3\,\text{ab}^{-1}$, ten produced inclusive events would require $\sigma \geq 10/(3000\,\text{fb}^{-1}) = 0.00333$ fb. The all-bottom decay fraction under the representative SM $h \to b\bar{b}$ value 0.582 is approximately $0.582^3 \simeq 0.197$ before six-tag inefficiency; $4b2\tau$ or $4b2\gamma$ may improve background discrimination despite smaller branching ratios.

The decision criterion is physics feasibility: reliable SM event yield, theoretical sensitivity shape, reconstruction strategy and realistic background expectation. A null or tiny expected hhh yield is itself useful for redirecting the research towards hh or higher-energy exploratory scenarios.

18 A joint research roadmap and validation gates

The completed results suggest an ordered collaboration programme rather than independent, unrelated generator exercises. The first deliverable is a controlled Standard Model reference: agree on model version and electroweak scheme, Higgs branching fractions, beam energies, polarization signs, cuts and numerical settings, and then rerun representative CC and NC h/hh points with independent seeds. The forward NC region requires an explicit lepton-angle/p_T stability study. The historical four-bottom samples must be regenerated or coherently renormalized, and the NC complete-four-bottom versus associated-$b\bar{b}h$ discrepancy must be resolved at identical phase-space definitions.

Table 6: Proposed work packages; individual assignments should be agreed at the meeting, not presumed here.

Stage	Scientific task	Testable deliverable
I	Common SM cards, seeds, diagram/full-amplitude QA; NC forward tests; historical BR and sample reconciliation	Verified baseline archive and cross-section comparison
II	Gauge-consistent κ_3–$\kappa_{2W,2Z}$ grids, 1/2 TeV and polarization variants	Validated matrix-element templates and distributions
III	Showering, jet and lepton acceptance, $4b$ backgrounds, detector scenarios	Fiducial response matrices and background model
IV	Binned multi-channel likelihood with FCC-ee priors where justified	Qualified projected coupling sensitivity and degeneracy maps
V	SM hhh feasibility and possible κ_4 extension	Feasibility memo with honest yield/background thresholds

The distinctive paper-level question is whether *combined polarized CC and NC Higgs-pair production, calibrated by single Higgs and differential observables*, can disentangle Higgs self-interactions from gauge-Higgs contact modifications. This goes beyond showing energy-growing SM cross sections. Existing lepton-collider $hhWW$ analyses, including the 2024 study by Cao, Cheng, Liu and Wang [3], already provide a baseline of prior phenomenology. A novel claim must be supported by improved process complementarity, a realistic polarization/luminosity scenario or a genuinely multidimensional inference.

For the first collaboration meeting, decisions should include: the official machine working points and realistic polarized luminosities; choice of EFT/HEFT model and operator basis; ranking CC/NC channels for detector work; common branching-ratio and decay treatment; reproducibility checks and code/data ownership; and concrete milestones for the first shared phenomenology note. These decisions should be explicitly recorded before a paper sensitivity plot is generated.

19 Conclusions and scientific references

The MG calculations establish an internally consistent preliminary LO baseline for μ^+e^- Higgs physics: CC h and hh rates are generally greater than corresponding NC rates; the normalized antimuon polarization enhancement is near $1 + p$ for CC and around $1 + 0.22p$ for NC; and hh production rises much faster than single-H production between exact 1 and 2 TeV. Original full-process MadGraph diagrams demonstrate that the trilinear scalar exchange, separate Higgs-emission graphs and $hhVV$ contact graphs are included together with interference. Earlier four-bottom and muon-collider associated-Zh calculations extend the phenomenological context but have distinct phase-space cuts, branching-ratio inputs and normalization limitations.

The physics programme now must progress from SM benchmarks to consistently parametrized κ_3–κ_{2V} grids, differential m_{hh} information, validated event and detector selections, and likelihood fits including luminosity and polarization constraints. Triple-Higgs is worth a tightly scoped feasibility test, not an unsupported κ_4 precision claim. The first indispensable tasks remain the independent-seed and forward-region checks and reconciliation of the older four-bottom samples. These define a scientifically defensible path from a successful computing campaign to a credible collaborative Higgs-coupling analysis.

Selected references and primary input sources

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